

Steven Boada, Ph.D

Basic Information	(615) 200-0119 stevenboada@gmail.com	github.com/boada linkedin.com/in/theboada
Professional Experience	Activision Publishing, Inc. Lead Data Scientist, Gameplay As part of the game science team, I lead data science strategy and cross-functional analytics initiatives to improve gameplay systems and player experience across Call of Duty. In this role, I: ● Define and prioritize high-impact analytics initiatives with design leadership, identifying opportunities to improve gameplay systems and drive measurable engagement outcomes. ● Drive cross-functional analytical efforts to understand how gameplay systems (maps, modes, weapons, communication systems, etc.) influence player behavior and top-line KPIs, translating insights into actionable design recommendations. ● Own experimentation strategy for gameplay features, guiding the design and evaluation of A/B tests, statistical models, and large-scale player behavior analyses. ● Establish analytical frameworks, dashboards, and reporting used by stakeholders to monitor gameplay health and evaluate design decisions. ● Champion gameplay measurement strategy and data quality, partnering with engineering to improve telemetry coverage, instrumentation, and analytical reliability. ● Elevate team analytical capability by mentoring data scientists, reviewing experimental designs and analyses, and promoting best practices in experimentation, statistics, and data storytelling. Senior Data Scientist, Gameplay As part of the game science team, I applied data science and experimentation to evaluate gameplay systems and improve player engagement across Call of Duty. In this role, I: ● Partnered with design leadership and cross-functional teams to define success metrics, evaluate gameplay systems, and deliver analyses that informed game design and product decisions. ● Led analytical projects examining how gameplay systems (maps, modes, weapons, communication systems, etc.) influence player behavior and top-line KPIs. ● Designed and implemented experiments (A/B tests), statistical analyses, and data models to evaluate gameplay features and quantify their impact on engagement and retention. ● Built dashboards, analyses, and visualizations that surfaced player behavior patterns and gameplay insights for designers and product stakeholders. ● Improved gameplay telemetry and data quality by collaborating with engineering teams to expand instrumentation and strengthen analytics pipelines. ● Mentored junior data scientists through guidance on study design, statistical analysis, and effective communication of insights.	Boulder, Colorado 2026 – Present
	Senior Machine Learning Engineer As part of the game science team, I designed and implemented ML infrastructure and tools to support data-driven decision-making. In this role, I: ● Designed, built, and maintained ML infrastructure and tools, including autoML, CI/CD (Jenkins, GitHub Actions), model tracking (MLflow), and orchestration (Airflow) to support data-driven decision-making. ● Crafted and implemented policy for external data ingestion and retention to ensure accessibility and proper data stewardship across the organization. ● Developed near-realtime applications (via Spark streaming) to identify and mitigate in-game cheating and malicious behaviors, achieving action times in the low 10s of seconds. ● Spearheaded the transition of ML infrastructure from AWS to GCP/GCS, optimizing scalability and performance. ● Created machine learning models focused on customer conversion, churn prediction, and behavioral segmentation using survival analysis, clustering, and tree-based techniques. ● Managed the day to day of a small team of junior data scientists to design, develop, and deploy recommendation systems that were integrated into Modern Warfare 2 (2022) and Modern Warfare 3 (2023).	January, 2024 – 2026 January, 2021 – 2024
	Insight Data Science As part of the game science team, I designed and implemented ML infrastructure and tools to support data-driven decision-making. In this role, I: ● Designed, built, and maintained ML infrastructure and tools, including autoML, CI/CD (Jenkins, GitHub Actions), model tracking (MLflow), and orchestration (Airflow) to support data-driven decision-making. ● Crafted and implemented policy for external data ingestion and retention to ensure accessibility and proper data stewardship across the organization. ● Developed near-realtime applications (via Spark streaming) to identify and mitigate in-game cheating and malicious behaviors, achieving action times in the low 10s of seconds. ● Spearheaded the transition of ML infrastructure from AWS to GCP/GCS, optimizing scalability and performance. ● Created machine learning models focused on customer conversion, churn prediction, and behavioral segmentation using survival analysis, clustering, and tree-based techniques. ● Managed the day to day of a small team of junior data scientists to design, develop, and deploy recommendation systems that were integrated into Modern Warfare 2 (2022) and Modern Warfare 3 (2023).	New York, New York

Senior Machine Learning Engineer

Insight Data Science

Fellow

January, 2020 – 2021

- Completed a data science bootcamp focused on transitioning academics into the tech industry, working on real-world data problems.
- Built a random forest model in Python to prioritize NYC restaurant inspections, improving violation detection by 2.5% and identifying critical issues up to 7 days earlier through an AWS-deployed API.

Skills

Machine Learning: Linear Models, Decision Trees, SVM, Clustering, Deep Learning, Survival Analysis

CI/CD: Jenkins, Airflow, Docker

Software and Computing: Open Source Contributor, Python, DataBricks, MLFlow, SQL, AWS/GCP, Spark, etc.

Leadership: Experience organizing and leading workshops and collaboration meetings, Teaching and mentoring junior team members, Eagle Scout.

Education

Texas A&M University, College Station, Texas

- Ph.D, Physics (astronomy focus), 2016

The University of Tennessee, Knoxville, Tennessee

- M.S., Physics (astronomy focus), 2009
- B.S., Physics, 2007